Corpus Linguistics

Reading argument 6

Name: _____ ID: _____

Question 1 Section IV-3

Section IV-3 argues against the causativization account of "passive" unaccusatives. Which of the following is NOT used by the author as evidence against this account?

_____

① In every L1 group, tokens of *be* + *en* outnumbered nonce causatives.

② Only one token in the corpus was clearly a genuine verbal passive of a nonce causative.

③ Han reports "passive" unaccusative errors in two Chinese learners who produced no nonce causatives.

④ No nonce causatives based on nonalternating unaccusatives appeared in the corpus.

Question 2 Section IV-3

The author argues that many "passive" unaccusatives cannot be plausibly interpreted as passives of causatives. Classify each sentence in (i)–(iv) (which are all quoted from a learner corpus) as one of Explanations 1–3 below. Then, explain your choice for (iii) in one sentence.

> Explanation 1: There is no plausible causer, because the event is beyond anyone's intentional control.
> Explanation 2: The most plausible causer is the subject NP itself, so causativization is unnecessary.
> Explanation 3: The sentence can be read as a genuine verbal passive of a nonce causative.

(i) *…the word, "the role of women", is appeared just several years ago.* *Explanation* _____

(ii) *You are arrived in the eternity city.* *Explanation* _____

(iii) *It was falled down in order to get a bigger green house.* *Explanation* _____

(iv) *…to find out what would be happened in the next stories…* *Explanation* _____

Question 3 Section IV-4

The lack-of-a-logical-subject analysis predicts that learners will associate *be* + *en* with the *absence of a logical subject*.

(a) According to this analysis, would sentences like **It arrived three boys at the station* (it–V–NP, without *be* + *en*) be expected to appear in learner English? Why or why not?

(b) The corpus contained 33 tokens of "expletive–V–NP" (without *be* + *en*), but the author says that only 29 of them are especially damaging to the analysis. Which 29 are they, and why are they more damaging than the other 4?

Question 4 Section IV-5

Rutherford's examples (e.g., *On the walls of this monument are written the names…*) contain *be* + *en* but the NP stays in the object position. Why does the author say these examples do **not** contradict the movement-marker analysis? Answer in 1–2 sentence